Apple Inc.

AAPL NASDAQ

Buy	$340.97 ▲ 1.29%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$375.00	$243.42 – $345.34	$4.98T

AAPL: Near 52-Week Highs as Cook Cashes Out

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL is grinding to fresh 52-week highs ($340.97, sitting at 96% of its yearly range) on lighter volume — that's the market saying "I'm comfortable owning this into earnings," not panic buying. The 5-day move is steady and boring, which for a $4.98T company is actually bullish — mega-caps rarely explode, they drift.
- The disconnect worth flagging: Tim Cook dumped ~$50M of stock on Oct 2, and the General Counsel sold too. Insider cluster selling right at highs isn't a sell signal by itself (Cook sells on schedules), but combined with options traders piling into October $340 calls at 13x normal volume, you've got insiders handing shares to speculators. That's a late-cycle setup.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what the tape is really telling you: Apple is being treated as a defensive mega-cap right now — notice Energy and Consumer Staples (classic defensive/inflation hedges) are leading the sector table. Money isn't chasing growth; it's parking in quality names with fortress balance sheets, and Apple fits that bill. The unusual call buying at $340 strike expiring THIS month suggests traders are betting on a near-term catalyst — likely the iPhone 17 holiday-quarter guidance when they report. If that print disappoints even slightly, the air pocket below is real because there's no valuation cushion at these levels. Cook's selling tells me management doesn't see shares as a screaming bargain here either.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

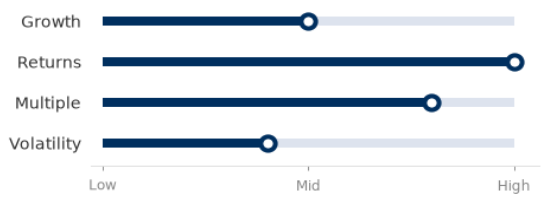
The single biggest policy variable for Apple is the US-China tariff framework — Apple still assembles the majority of iPhones in China, and any escalation in Section 301 tariffs flows straight through to margins (every 10% tariff bump = roughly $0.50-0.70 off EPS if not passed to consumers). Also watch the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement actions: the EU has been forcing Apple to open up the App Store to sideloading and alternative payment systems, which chips away at their highest-margin business (Services, ~70% gross margin). On the friendly side, the CHIPS Act subsidies continue to benefit Apple's US-based silicon partners (TSMC Arizona), which de-risks their supply chain politically — a quiet tailwind nobody talks about.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	**$340.97**
12M Price Target	**$375.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+10.0%**
Market Cap	**$4.98T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$445M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$478M**
FY2026E EPS	**$7.95**
FY2027E EPS	**$8.80**
Fwd P/E	**42.9x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

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PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$358.00**	$345.00	**$320.00**
6 Months	**$390.00**	$360.00	**$300.00**
1 Year	**$420.00**	$375.00	**$285.00**
2 Years	**$490.00**	$410.00	**$270.00**
5 Years	**$650.00**	$500.00	**$300.00**
10 Years	**$950.00**	$700.00	**$350.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+4% 5D) and Consumer Staples (+4.2% 5D) — classic defensive rotation, suggests money is nervous about growth but still wants to be invested. Real Estate rallying (+3% 5D) hints the rate-cut narrative is back on.

COOLING OFF: Communication Services is flat-to-down over 5 days — that's unusual and tells me the mega-cap tech trade is getting tired or at least pausing.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from pure-growth tech into "quality defensive" names — Apple benefits because it's seen as both. But if the rotation continues into true defensives (staples, utilities), Apple could stall even if nothing goes wrong fundamentally.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Apple AI story, the picks-and-shovels play is TSMC (TSM) — they make the chips — and Broadcom (AVGO) for the networking/custom silicon side. Both have more operating leverage to an AI-device cycle than Apple itself.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Winning on enterprise AI monetization — Copilot attach rates are showing up in Azure growth, and the market is paying for proven AI revenue.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the purest AI play — every incremental hyperscaler capex announcement flows to their top line.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is a laggard in the AI mega-cap bucket because its AI strategy (Apple Intelligence) is a feature, not a revenue line. It's keeping up with the market, not leading it. That tells me AAPL is being bought for safety and buybacks, not for AI upside — which caps the near-term multiple expansion but also limits downside versus pure AI names if sentiment flips.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: $320-328 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China tariff escalation above 25% or iPhone unit sales decline >8% YoY

Hedging: Buy protective puts 10% below current price, or pair with a China-exposed hardware short

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